

South Korea Aerospace & Defense: Potential inflection point in beaten down sentiment

Hanwha Aerospace (Hanwha) and Hyundai Rotem (Rotem) closed higher at +6.3%/+10.7% on Friday outperforming Kospi (+4.5%) by +1.8ppt/+6.2pt, respectively. We note that share prices continued to slide down over the past few months, which came after a re-rating in valuation during Mar-Apr period on expectations surrounding the Middle East's swift restocking of air defense systems (refer to our [past report](#) on Middle East air missile defense system opportunities). We attribute such lackluster market sentiment to the prolonged tensions in the region, which put discussions on the potential order pipelines on hold and left limited sector catalysts post 1Q results ([Exhibit 1](#) & [Exhibit 2](#)).

In that sense, Friday's share price strength was likely driven by [media reports](#) of a potential US-Iran peace agreement, which we believe would be a critical catalyst needed for both Hanwha And Rotem in advancing talks on the pending potential orders that we continue to highlight ([Exhibit 3](#) & [Exhibit 4](#)). As such, our view is that any further development towards peace would lead up to the market incrementally pricing back in the order pipelines. As a recap, at a 100% win-rate, we see W95.5tn, W89.5tn potential orders for Hanwha and Rotem, which would translate to GSe EPS CAGR of 32%/48% during 2025-2028 under our probability-weighted model. We reiterate Hanwha (TP W1.8mn) and Rotem (W280k) as BUYS.

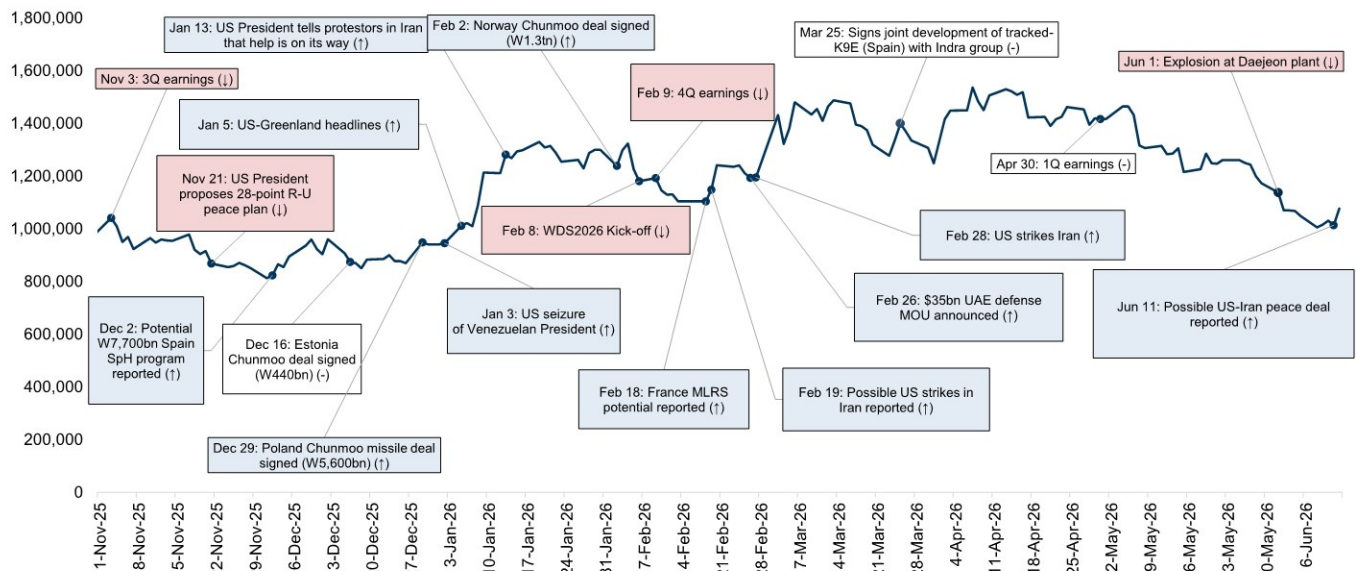
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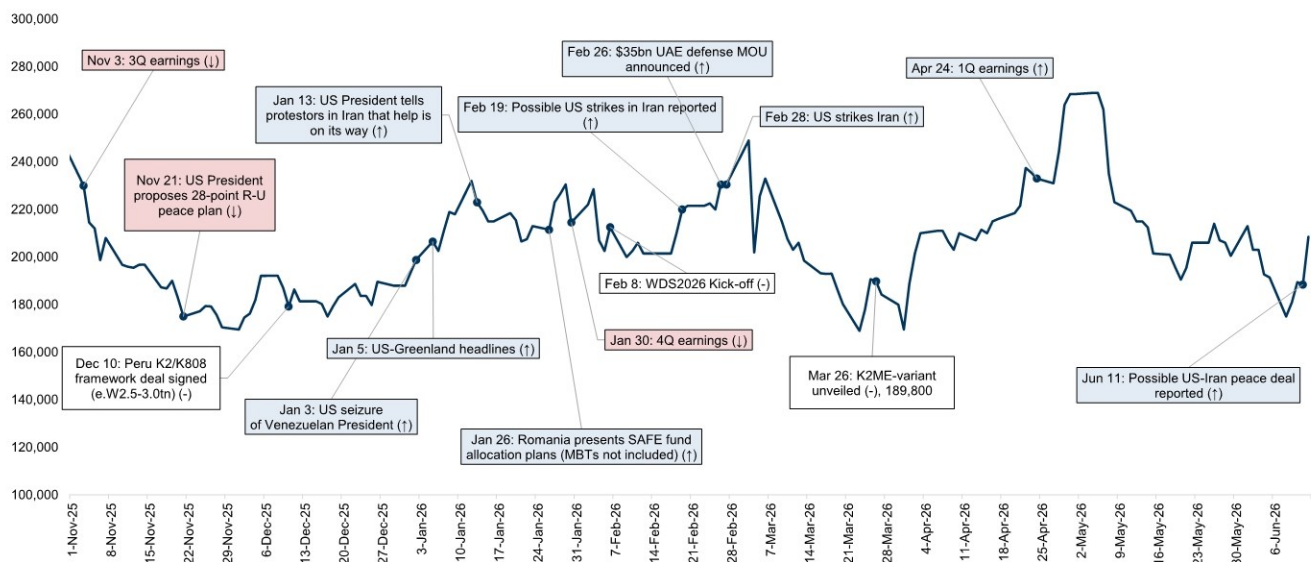
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Exhibit 1: Hanwha Aerospace share price has been falling since April highs - key events

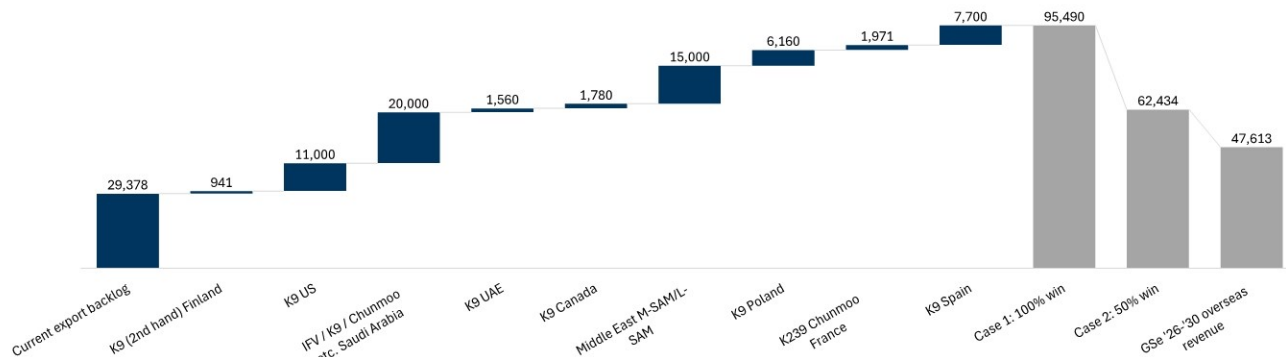
Source: Quantiwise, Various media reports, Compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: Hyundai Rotem share price has been falling since April highs - key events

Source: Quantiwise, Various media reports, Compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 3: At 100%/50% win-rate, the key potential order pipeline would push up Hanwha's export backlog to W95tn/62tn which exceeds GSe 26-30% overseas revenue

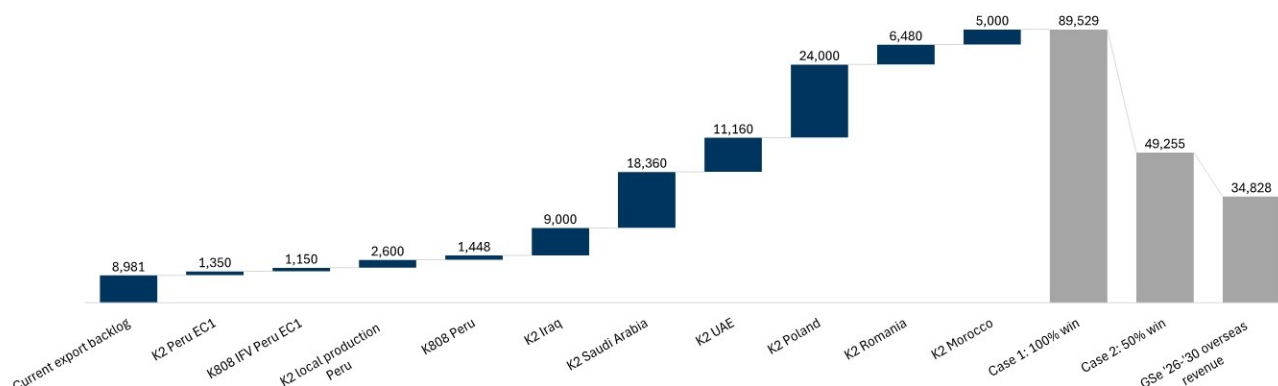
GSe Hanwha Aerospace order potentials



Source: Company data, Various media reports, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 4: At a 100%/50% win-rate, the key potential order pipeline would push up Rotem's export backlog to W90tn/49tn, which exceeds GSe 2026-2030E overseas revenue

Hyundai Rotem order potentials



Source: Company data, Various media reports, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Hanwha Aerospace

Our 12-month target price of W1,800,000 is based on a target P/E multiple of 28.0x applied to 2027E EPS. Key risks include: 1) lower-than-expected order wins, 2) lower-than-expected OPM from overseas production, 3) lower-than-expected demand from NATO's Eastern Flank and MENA countries, 4) regional geopolitical developments resulting in shift in focus to domestic procurement, and 5) stronger KRW against the USD.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Hyundai Rotem

Our 12-month target price of W280,000 is based on a target P/E multiple of 20.8x applied to 2027E EPS. Key risks include: 1) lower-than-expected order wins, 2) lower-than-expected OPM from overseas production, 3) lower-than-expected demand from NATO's Eastern Flank and MENA countries, 4) regional geopolitical developments

resulting in shift in focus to domestic procurement, and 5) stronger KRW against the USD.

Disclosure Appendix

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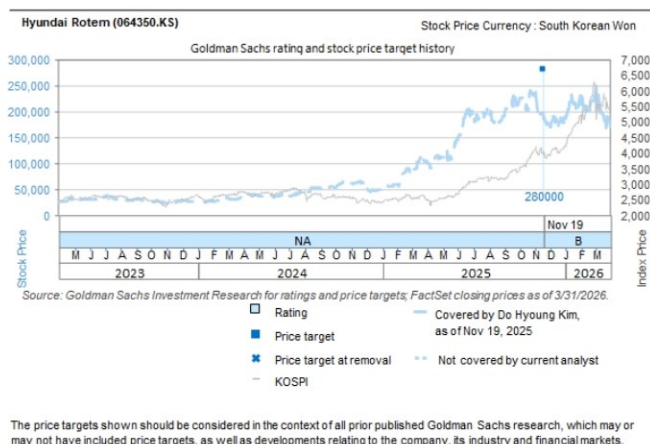
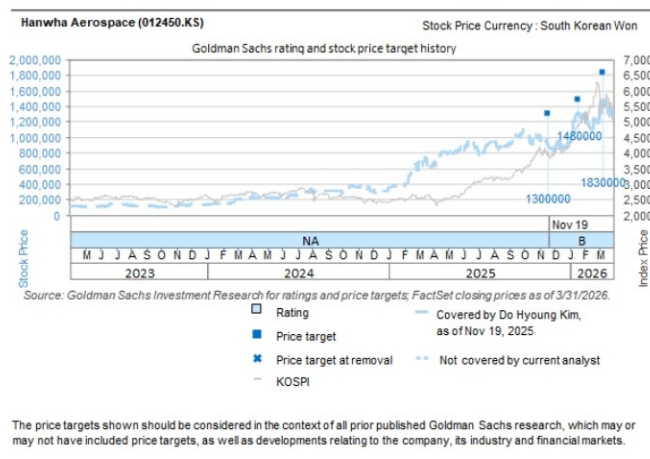
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Price target and rating history chart(s)



Target price history table(s)

Hyundai Rotem (064350.KS)

Date of report	Target price (W)	Closing price (W)
19-Nov-25	280,000	186,800

Hanwha Aerospace (012450.KS)

Date of report	Target price (W)	Closing price (W)
30-Apr-26	1,800,000	1,417,000
10-Mar-26	1,830,000	1,455,000
20-Jan-26	1,480,000	1,309,000
19-Nov-25	1,300,000	905,000

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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